

SOULED OUT

Many people are sold on the idea that every new baby comes complete with a soul. In the Christian religion, God creates all of the souls and gives them out to humans. Believing in Jesus is said to "save" your soul and guarantee entry to an eternal life in heaven. Many folktales tell of selling your soul or making a pact with the devil to exchange your soul for something you want badly, such as power, knowledge, or eternal youth.

LOST SOULS

In the early 1900s, an American doctor weighed dying patients and determined that each person lost 0.046 lb (0.021 kg) at the point of death. Was this the soul escaping? Scientists remain skeptical, but if you believe in life after death, you probably believe that your soul survives the body's physical demise and goes on to whatever comes after: heaven or hell, or into a new body. Some believe that after you die, your soul goes to meet God. It is judged by what type of person you were in life; then God decides the final fate of your soul.

SOULLESS SCIENCE

Perhaps humans are soulless. In fact, there is strong scientific evidence against the existence of a soul. All of the stuff that is attributed to the soul is, in reality, a by-product of neural activity within the brain. Studies have found that different areas of the brain "light up" to show activity when a person does a mental task, and we know which regions of the brain control our consciousness. So maybe the soul is just a figment of our imaginations. However, for many people, this is a soul-destroying thought, and they insist that we all have souls and each of us has a soul mate out there.